



European Fencing Confederation Confédération Européenne d'Escrime

May, 8th 2026

Statement of the EFC Executive committee

1. Rationale

The statement and proposed procedure set out below are intended to provide a practical and legally sound path forward, in full respect of the Statutes and Internal Rules of the EFC, the applicable FIE framework, and general principles of applicable law.

Having considered the legal opinion of the EFC Legal Commission, the Executive Committee is of the view that the objectives pursued by the co-sponsored proposals cannot be achieved through the procedural mechanism proposed in the co-sponsored proposals.

Even if adopted by Congress, the proposals relating to the lifting of the suspension of the Russian and Belarusian Fencing Federations would not produce the intended legal effect under the current Statutes

The Executive Committee therefore considers that addressing the matter through the appropriate statutory procedures is the most efficient and constructive approach. This would avoid unnecessary procedural debate while preserving the substance and spirit of co-sponsored proposals.

Accordingly, and in the interest of procedural clarity and efficiency, the Executive Committee respectfully invites the Federations of Türkiye, Serbia and Bulgaria to withdraw their proposals.

2. Introduction

- In response to the submission of a proposal to “lift the suspension of the Belarusian and Russian Federation” by three Member Federations of the EFC;
- After reviewing the legal opinion of the EFC Legal Commission on the subject;
- Considering that the proposals submitted by the Serbian, Bulgarian and Turkish Fencing Federations, are identical in wording and should therefore be treated as a co-sponsored proposal for procedural reasons (to avoid three separate, time consuming votes on the same subject), and where each submitting Member Federation conserves speaking rights;
- Considering that the co-sponsored proposal in fact contains two substantially different proposals, which require two separate votes:



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- one on lifting the suspension of the Russian and Belarussian Fencing Federation (Proposal 1)
- one on the participation in EFC Competitions of Athletes and Officials from Russia and Belarus (Proposal 2);
- Considering further that the EFC is bound per its Statutes to treat all member federations equally while remaining politically neutral and respecting the Olympic truce.

3. Statement

The EFC Executive Committee puts forward the following statement on the interpretation of the situation at hand:

Proposal 1

The first part of the co-sponsored proposal which concerns the lifting of the suspension of the Russian and Belarussian Fencing Federations, is formally admissible. However, agreeing with the legal opinion, the Executive Committee considers it legally misconceived.

This is because the Russian and Belarussian fencing federations are deemed to have resigned on the grounds of article 2.13 of the Statutes by failing to pay their annual membership fee since the year 2023. (Additionally, in the case of the Russian Fencing Federation, not reimbursing the fees following a CAS Award). As a result, they are no longer member federations.

Since they are no longer member federations, questions about their suspension fall outside the competence of Congress.

Even if Congress votes in favour, this would not reinstate or lift any suspension on the Russian and Belarussian Fencing Federations, because a resigned Federation cannot be “unsuspended”..

In this context, the Executive Committee considers that the only proper way to admit the Russian and Belarussian Fencing Federations as members is through an application for readmission to membership, not as a new application for membership under Article 1.19 of the Statutes.

In light thereof, Fencing Federations that have been deemed resigned and that reapply for Membership should therefore be treated as applicants for re-admission. They should not be treated as new members and should not receive the benefits



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granted to new members.

Furthermore, the Executive Committee confirms that, in line with the applicable Statutes and Internal Rules, any application for readmission can be examined only after the Federation has fully paid all outstanding debts, charges, penalties, and any other monies owed to the EFC.

Once all outstanding debts are fully settled, the Federation may apply to the EFC Executive Committee for re-admission to membership. The Executive Committee shall then examine this application using the same statutory rules that apply to ordinary membership applications, including Articles 2.6 to 2.9, 2.11 and 2.12.

If the conditions are met, the Executive Committee can proceed with granting provisional membership, subject to ratification by Congress.

Proposal 2

The Executive Committee believes that the implementation of the second part of the co-sponsored proposal - concerning the participation of athletes and officials from Russia and Belarus in EFC competitions - requires an amendment to the Internal Rules.

4. Conclusion

To this end, a Comex provision has been drafted to amend Internal Rule Article 1.28. Under this proposal, athletes and individuals who meet the required conditions may take part in EFC activities as "AIN" (individual Neutral Athletes).

If or when the Belarusian or Russian Fencing federation have put forward an application to be re-admitted as members, the Executive Committee of the EFC will include this amended Article 1.28 into the Internal Rules.

The Executive Committee amends the Administrative Rules. Under this amendment, host countries of EFC-events are not penalized if their countries do not accept Russian and/or Belarusian citizens to access the country. At the same time the Executive Committee strongly encourages all organisers to support the issue of visa for everyone irrespective of nationalities.

The following Congress would then need to ratify those membership re-admissions and Internal Rules provisions.